

infrastructure, fed the destitute, and regulated otherwise broken-down municipal authorities, any goodwill this generated among the local population was often dissipated by vicious guerrilla reprisals against civilians who had cooperated with Union forces. Union officers in parts of Virginia, Tennessee, and Mississippi especially struggled as they occupied, evacuated, and then reoccupied locales after major Confederate incursions. As General Benjamin Butler said in 1862, "It is cruel to take possession of any point unless we continue to hold it with an armed force, because when we take possession of any place those well disposed will show us kindness and good wishes; the moment we leave, a few ruffians come in and maltreat every person who has not scowled at the Yankees."